

When the verdict is confident — and wrong

A second *Strongly Disagree* from the same book page — this one a category error. It shows how the pipeline can be certain and still misread the claim.

△ STRONGLY DISAGREE • OVER-STRONG LOGIC

SOURCE — THE MANUSCRIPT

وجه تعذيبه
[أزاد رخت] بالمعجمة فارسي ويسمى الطاحك وبمصر الزنزلخت وبالشام الجرود وهو
شجر يقارب الصفصاف أملس الورق إلى السواد مرّ الطعم ثمره كالزعرور في عناقيد يدرك
آخر الربيع ويدوم طويلا وهو حار في الثالثة يابس في الثانية أو الأولى يفتح السدد ويدرّ
الفضلات ويقاوم السموم عصارة وطبيخا وشربا ويمنع الغثيان طلاء ويفتح الحصى مطلقا
ويحلل الخنازير الصداع نطولا وثمرته تقتل ويعالج شاربها بالقى وشرب اللبن وأكل التفاح
والرمان وسائر أجزائه حراقة وعصارته تبرئ قروح الرأس وتطول الشعر إذا وضعت عليه

Tadhkirat Dawud al-Antaki • page ٥١ • the أزاد رخت (Melia azedarach) entry • same page as the Asarum trace

... يفتح السدد ويدرّ الفضلات ويقاوم السموم عصارة وطبيخا وشربا ... وثمرته تقتل

...

“... it opens obstructions, promotes excretion, and counteracts toxins as juice, decoction, or drink
... and its fruit kills ...”

Note: the book itself already says the fruit is deadly. The claim under test is the plant’s action against poisons — an antidote use — not that the plant is harmless.

CLAIM — EXTRACTED (ENTRY 43)

PLANT

أزاد رخت — *Melia azedarach* (chinaberry)

CONDITION

Toxins

CLAIMED EFFECT

Counteracts toxins (يقاوم السموم) — i.e. an antidote

NORMALIZE — MODERN TERMS

FIRST SLIP

poisoning

envenomation

toxicosis

toxicity

intoxication

“Counteracts toxins” collapsed into “toxicity / poisoning.” The antidote direction was lost — so the search now looks for the plant and toxicity, which for a toxic plant can only find one thing.

RETRIEVE — EUROPE PMC

"Melia azedarach" AND (poisoning OR envenomation OR toxicosis OR toxicity OR intoxication)

FILTER — KEPT PAPERS, ALL ABOUT THE PLANT'S OWN TOXICITY

25

PAPERS FOUND

4

KEPT

▀ **Emerging Plant Intoxications in Domestic Animals: A European Perspective**

doi:10.3390/toxins15070442

▀ **Ecotoxicological evaluation of an aqueous phytoextract of Melia azedarach**

doi:10.1016/j.scitotenv.2024.175314

▀ **Comparative bioassays — Melia fruit most toxic; neurotoxic effects of aqueous extract**

toxicity assays

Strongly Disagree

confidence 1.00 · model gemini-3-flash-preview

“Melia azedarach is itself a **source** of toxicity, not a treatment for it — a leading cause of poisoning in animals; its fruit is the most toxic in comparative bioassays. The evidence contradicts using it as an antidote and warns it is a toxic substance.”

Every fact here is true — Melia really is toxic. But the verdict answers the wrong question.

WHERE THE LOGIC BREAKS

⚠️ A category error, not a real disagreement

The book claims the plant *acts against* poisons (an antidote). The pipeline instead asked “is Melia toxic?” — found, correctly, that it is — and treated that as a refutation. Being poisonous does not mean it cannot counteract a poison. Two things went wrong:

- 1 · **Normalization** — turned “counteracts toxins” into “toxicity / poisoning,” steering the search to the wrong literature.
- 2 · **Judgment** — conflated “the plant is toxic” with “the plant is ineffective as an antidote.” A safety fact used as an efficacy verdict.

The right output would be a **safety flag** (“this plant is toxic — the fruit can be fatal”), which is genuinely valuable — not a confident *Strongly Disagree* with the antidote claim.

Fully machine-logged in factcheck_trace_v1_base1.jsonl (entry 43, condition "Toxins"). Same source page as the Asarum trace (p. 53). This is one of the ~2 of 9 disagreements driven by over-strong logic; the other ~3 (Asarum, basil, chamomile-fatigue) are genuinely correct.